

Meriç Erler

Game Economy Designer - F2P & Idle Systems

Berlin, Germany | mericerler@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/mericerler | github.com/merogith
EU work-authorized | English (full professional), Turkish (native) | Available immediately

Summary

I work a game economy from three sides at once: as a P&L, as a design system, and as the code that runs it. Three years as a business and financial data analyst (pharma, edtech, equity research) built the first; moving into game economy design and building my own games built the rest. Economic modelling, statistics, monetization and KPIs are the toolkit; the Idle Bank Tycoon case study, my portfolio and the cover letter are the evidence.

Core Skills

- **Game economy & F2P:** economy modelling and balancing; sources/sinks and inflation control; progression curves; monetization (IAP, rewarded ads, ARPDau, ARPPU, eCPM); retention (D1/D7/D30); player psychology, motivation and segmentation.
- **Spreadsheet modelling:** advanced Excel and Google Sheets - parameter-driven models, 400+ linked formulas, sensitivity grids, scenario and A/B design.
- **Data analysis & methods:** Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels); SQL (window functions); A/B testing; regression; z-tests; logistic models; forecasting.
- **BI & reporting:** Tableau, Power BI, Looker Studio, Google Analytics, KPI dashboards.
- **Build / technical:** custom game engines in JavaScript / TypeScript (Canvas, game loop, rules-vs-render separation); concepts that carry over to Unity; Supabase; Git.

Selected Projects

- **Idle Bank Tycoon - Game Economy Design Case Study** (economy design, monetization, A/B). A redesign aimed at exactly what this role owns: I diagnosed a late-game cash glut, then designed two live-ops monetization levers with anti-inflation guardrails, all in a documented, parameter-driven spreadsheet model. Modelled to a blended ~+15.5% ARPDau, but the part I would point to is the call: ship the lower-risk ad lever first and treat the loan as a retention bet to be measured, not assumed. Full math, sensitivity and sources in the linked study.
- **Free-to-Play Game Economy & Balance** (Python, scikit-learn, SQL). The closest analog to live balancing: in a real F2P economy I caught two exploit-grade premium items and a slow currency inflation and shipped the fixes, the unexpected-behaviour problem this role exists to prevent. I also turned first-days cohort data into a model that flags likely payers early, the basis for a concrete onboarding lever. Methods and results in the portfolio.
- **US Stock-Market Valuation & Risk** (Python, statsmodels, SQL). The financial-analyst foundation under the design work: a 150-year study linking market valuation to long-run returns and drawdown risk, built to drive a real allocation call. Full analysis in the portfolio.
- **Games I designed & balanced** (custom JavaScript engines). Proof I balance economies inside real, playable games: Battle, a turn-based RPG with online PvP where every stat and reward has to stay fair, and RocketIO, a real-time strategy game built on a resource-and-missile economy. Both run on engines I wrote myself; playable in the portfolio (merogith.github.io/Portfolio).
- **Next on my list - idle games.** A Classic-WoW-style RPG reimagined as an idle game, the genre I spend the most time in (Clicker Heroes, Tap Titans, Slayer Legend, Idle Slayer, Legends of Idleon).

Experience

Independent Financial Coach - Self-employed (2024 - Present)

- Run a one-to-one practice turning budgeting, saving and investing into plain, actionable decisions; design each client's plan and run weekly check-ins in English and Turkish.

Omnichannel Data Analyst - Viatrix Inc. (Dec 2022 - Sep 2023)

- Consolidated records into one master record per person across 70+ markets (Salesforce); fuzzy matching cut manual validation by 40%; cleaned 1M+ records with SQL.

Business Intelligence Analyst - Saksı Kampüs (early-stage edtech) (Dec 2021 - Oct 2022)

- Tracked retention, engagement and CAC in Google Analytics and Looker Studio and steered Meta Ads spend; wrote the business plan and growth projections behind a seed crowdfunding raise.

Sales & Financial Analysis Intern - Garanti BBVA Investment (Jul 2021 - Sep 2021)

- Built DCF and comparable-company valuation models and set target prices for sell-side equity research.

Education

- M.Sc. Corporate Management - University of Europe for Applied Sciences, Berlin (2022 - 2024).
- B.Sc. Environmental Engineering - METU, Ankara (2013 - 2021).

Honors: published paper "Generative AI in Pharma" (ADCAIJ); Google AI Essentials; METU summer-practice award.

Languages

English (full professional); Turkish (native); Portuguese (dual citizen).